

Rosaceae *Rose family · ~4800 spp.*

Shared characters Perigynous–epigynous hypanthium · Leaves alternate, stipulate

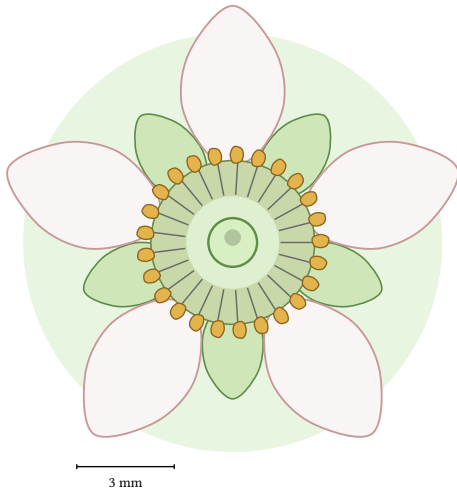
General formula:

$\ast, K_{3-10}, C_{0-10}, A_{1-\infty}, (\overline{G}_{1-\infty})$ achene, drupelets, follicle, drupe, pome

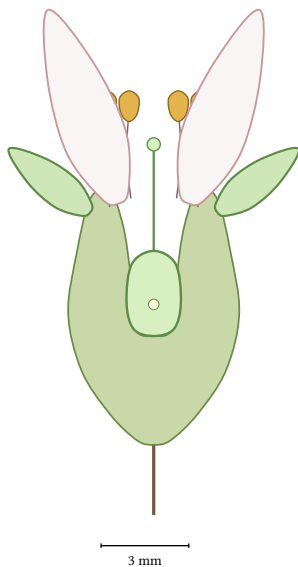
Prunus padus L.

Bird Cherry · bisexual

$\ast, K_5, C_5, A_{23-30}, \underline{G}_1$ drupe



Top view — 5 petals, 25 stamens,
1 carpel; perigynous hypanthium rim visible



Longitudinal section — cup-shaped hypanthium;
ovary superior ($\underline{G}$: free inside cup)

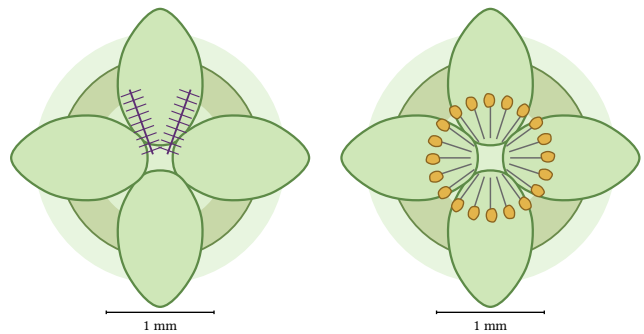
Poterium sanguisorba L.

Salad Burnet · wind-pollinated · monoecious

$\varnothing \ast, K_4, C_0, A_0, \overline{G}_2$ achene

$\sigma \ast, K_4, C_0, A_{20-30}, G_0$

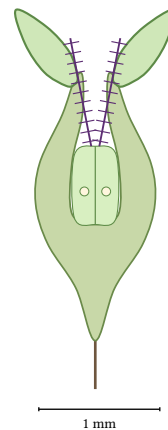
$\varnothing$: very enclosed hypanthium; carpels free (not fused to wall); tepals green
 σ : pendant stamens; occasionally rudimentary carpels present; tepals green



$\varnothing$ carpellate

σ staminate

Top views — K_4 , no petals; feathery stigmas ($\varnothing$)
or pendant stamens (σ); hypanthium mouth as ring



Longitudinal section ($\varnothing$) — urn-shaped hypanthium;
 $\overline{G}_2$: carpels enclosed but free from wall

Formula notation $\underline{G}$ = superior (hypogynous — other parts insert below ovary) · $\overline{G}$ = inferior (epigynous — other parts insert above ovary) **Contrast** In *Prunus* the ovary sits free inside an open cup (perigynous, superior). In *Poterium* the urn-shaped hypanthium deeply encloses the carpels; the carpels are free from the hypanthium wall but appear inferior because other parts insert at the mouth above them. Both share the polystemonous androecium and stipulate alternate leaves characteristic of Rosaceae.